

Elaphoglossum serpens

No common name

Family (Dryopteridaceae)

Kingdom (Plantae)

Status (Endangered)

Description

It's characterized by its fronds, which are divided into sterile and fertile types, each with distinct characteristics. The fern's habitat is limited to a specific elfin forest location on Cerro de Punta, the highest mountain in Puerto Rico.



Location/Habitat

The epiphytic fern *E. serpens* is historically known from only two sites on the highest peaks of the Puerto Rico's Central Mountain Range: Cerro Punta, and Monte Jayuya. These peaks are located within the Toro Negro Commonwealth Forest. Specific number of individuals for the population at Monte Jayuya has never been determined nor has it been visited since Proctor in 1991. For Cerro Punta, Proctor (1991) reported a population estimate of at least 22 individuals.

Sources: <https://www.fws.gov/species/search>

<https://ecos.fws.gov/ecp/report/species-listings-by-state-totals?statusCategory=Listed>

<https://efotg.sc.egov.usda.gov/#/state/CR/documents/section=4&folder=-3>